João Dimas

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Education

Washington University in St. Louis, Olin Business School 2022–2026

PhD in Finance

Advisor: Todd Gormley

Dissertation: The Economics of Technical Debt: Venture Capital, Cybersecurity, and Engineering Quality

Université Paris I Panthéon-Sorbonne

M.A. in Financial Economics 2018

M.Sc. in Economics 2017

Universidade FUMEC 2009

B.Sc. in Computer Science

Research Fields

Corporate finance and the economics of technology (AI, software quality, and cybersecurity).

Job Market Paper

Venture Capital and Engineering Quality: Evidence from Software Startups

with L. Pnevmatikos (third-year PhD student)

We study how venture capital affects the engineering practices through which startups build and maintain technology. Using longitudinal evaluations of software codebases, we find that serious coding problems and technical debt decline by 15% and 12%, respectively, after first VC investment relative to comparison firms. These improvements accompany codebase growth, greater documented peer review and formal issue tracking.

ssrn.com/abstract=6023094

Working Papers

Cybersecurity Vulnerabilities and Firm Performance

with L. Pnevmatikos

ssrn.com/abstract=6520342

Work in Progress

AI and Technical Debt: Evidence from 3 Billion Lines of Code

with E. Lu and L. Pnevmatikos

Acquisition Prospects and Startup Strategy

with A. Jain and L. Pnevmatikos

Hedge or Speculation? Evidence from Brazil

with Gustavo Cortes, Sergio Leao, and Alexandre Pecora

Industry Papers

Toh, W. Q., W. Zheng, Y. Wang, and J. Dimas (2025). A White Box Framework for Estimating Long-Term Experimental Impact via Short-Term Metrics. ACM KDD 4th End to End Customer Journey Optimization Workshop.

Honors

Buchan Prize, 1st place (best PhD student-written paper), with L. Pnevmatikos.

Conferences

12th Annual USC Marshall PhD Conference in Finance June 15, 2026
Job market paper, presented by L. Pnevmatikos.

Research and Professional Experience

Roblox 2025
PhD Data Scientist Intern, Experimentation Platform

- Developed methodology for estimating 365-day customer lifetime value treatment effects from 14-day experimental outcomes.
- Estimated engagement–monetization trade-offs and designed validation against realized long-run outcomes to inform experimentation-platform decisions.

Central Bank of Brazil (Banco Central do Brasil)
Economist, Research Department 2018–2021

- Contributed to research on inflation dynamics and monetary-policy transmission, producing forecasts and alternative macroeconomic scenarios to support policy decisions.
- Researched credit markets, banking efficiency, financial stability, and their effects on the real economy.
- Developed macroeconomic modeling and forecasting tools and reproducible empirical workflows; contributed analytical inputs to the Inflation Report and policy briefings.

Software Engineer, IT Department 2012–2016

CI&T 2008–2012
Software Engineer and Technical Lead

CEMIG 2007–2008
Software Engineer

References

Olin Business School, Washington University in St. Louis

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Zhiyu (Julie) Fu
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Armando Gomes
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